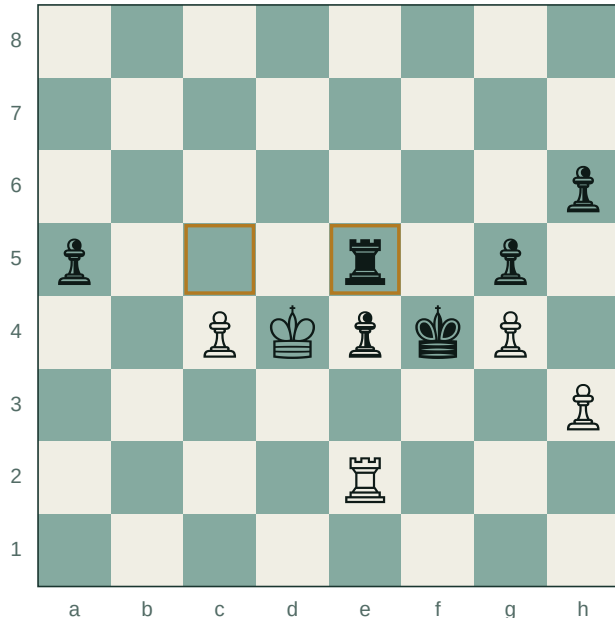


Deflection tactics: White, move 41

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 40...Re5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41. Rf2+ Kg3 42. Kxe5 Kxf2 43. Kxe4

41.Rf2+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **41...Kg3**.

42.Kxe5 The king captures the rook on e5. Recorded reply: **42...Kxf2**.

43.Kxe4 The king captures the pawn on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f4. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.